

Google Ads Account Audit

Full-funnel performance review, diagnosis & optimization roadmap

Vin Engineering INC

Reporting period

Last 30 days · Jun 23 – Jul 22, 2026

Account

Google Ads 566-536-4039 (CAD)

Prepared

July 23, 2026



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Executive summary

Vin Engineering's Google Ads account is a **young, single-campaign account with genuinely good fundamentals that is being held back by a small number of fixable issues**. In the last 30 days it spent **CAD \$1,472** and produced **13 leads** (9 form fills + 4 calls) at a **\$113 cost-per-lead**. Nothing here is "broken" — but roughly a third of every dollar is being taxed by a weak landing page, and about a quarter of available searches are missed because of it.

The single biggest lever: Google's own **landing-page (post-click) Quality Score is Below Average on nearly every keyword**. That low score is why the average click costs **\$7.44** (high for this niche) and why the campaign **loses 43.8% of available impressions to Ad Rank**. Fix the landing page and three things improve at once: lower CPCs, more impressions inside the same budget, and a better conversion rate — compounding into a materially lower cost-per-lead.

\$1,472 SPEND (30 DAYS)	13 LEADS (FORMS + CALLS)
\$113 COST / LEAD	6.21% CLICK-THROUGH RATE
\$7.44 AVG. COST-PER-CLICK	43.8% IMPR. LOST TO AD RANK

Top 5 things that went wrong (or are holding it back)

1. **Landing-page experience is rated Below Average by Google** across almost all keywords — the root cause of high CPCs and lost impressions. **Critical**
2. **Quality Scores are low** (many keywords at 1–5 out of 10), so you pay a premium on every click. **High**
3. **Wasted spend on off-target searches** — municipal permit-portal, out-of-area, DIY/how-to and wrong-service (deck/pool) queries leaking through phrase-match close variants. **High**
4. **Geo-targeting error:** the campaign targets **Cambridge, England (UK)** alongside the Ontario cities. **Medium**
5. **Automated bidding with no guardrail:** Maximize Conversions is running with no Target CPA, and Optimization Score sits at 55.5%. **Medium**

Conversion-tracking trust score



The tracked conversions are **real business actions** — lead-form submissions and phone calls, not shallow page-views — which is exactly what you want, and it means the \$113 cost-per-lead is trustworthy at face value. Points deducted because (a) tag firing, de-duplication and primary/secondary settings **cannot be verified through the reporting API** and need a manual check in Google Ads; (b) there are **two separate call actions** that may be double-counting the same calls; and (c) **booked/qualified jobs are not imported**, so Google is optimizing for lead **volume**, not revenue.

1 Account performance snapshot

Every core metric for the account over the last 30 days. All figures are pulled live from the Google Ads API — nothing is estimated.

Metric	Last 30 days	Read
Cost	CAD \$1,472.35	~\$49/day against a \$50/day budget
Impressions	3,188	Small, local footprint
Clicks	198	—
Click-through rate (CTR)	6.21%	Healthy for search — ads are relevant

Average CPC	\$7.44	High — driven by low Quality Scores
Conversions (leads)	13	9 form fills + 4 phone calls
Conversion rate	6.57%	Reasonable; capped by landing page
Cost / lead (CPA)	\$113.26	Acceptable for this vertical pending close-rate confirmation
Search impression share	34.0%	You appear for only 1 in 3 eligible searches
Impr. share lost to rank	43.8%	The big leak — quality/relevance, not budget
Impr. share lost to budget	22.2%	Budget is a secondary constraint
Optimization score	55.5%	Google sees meaningful room to improve

Context that matters: this is an early-stage campaign.

Daily data begins on Jun 23 and ramps up from a near-zero start, and every ad asset is still marked "Pending" (not enough data to grade). This account is likely only ~30-45 days old. That is **good news** — most of what we flag is normal early-stage tuning, not damage, and low-volume days should be read as "monitor," not "fail."

2 Conversion tracking & lead quality

Before trusting any performance number, we inventory **what is actually being counted as a "conversion."** A cheap cost-per-lead built on junk events (page views, button clicks) is a mirage. Here, the picture is encouraging.

Conversion action	Type	Conversions (30d)
Submit lead form – Pop Up	Lead form	8
Calls from Ads	Phone call	3
Call ((647) 548-8764)	Phone call	1
Submit lead form	Lead form	1
Total		13

Good: these are real business outcomes.

All four actions are genuine lead events — form submissions and phone calls — so the \$113 cost-per-lead reflects actual enquiries, not vanity metrics.

Verify manually (cannot be confirmed via the API):

- **Possible double-counting of calls.** "Calls from Ads" and "Call ((647) 548-8764)" may be recording the same phone calls twice — confirm one is not inflating your lead count.
- **Tag firing, de-duplication, attribution model and count settings** (every-vs-one) are not visible in reporting. Do a one-time check in Google Ads > Conversions.
- **No offline / booked-job import.** Google currently optimizes for **number of leads**, not **booked revenue**. Importing "qualified lead" and "job booked" from your CRM would let bidding chase profit, not just volume.

3 Campaign structure & settings

The whole account is **one Search campaign → one ad group ("Residential") → 26 keywords → 1 responsive search ad.**

Setting	Current	Assessment
Campaign	"Vin - City Permit - \$1200 offer"	Enabled & serving
Channel	Search only	Good
Networks	Google Search only (Search Partners & Display OFF)	Good — no low-quality network leakage
Location targeting type	Presence ("people in your areas")	Correct for a local service
Ad group structure	1 ad group, all themes mixed	Too broad — hurts ad relevance
Ads per ad group	1 responsive search ad	Thin — add a 2nd RSA to test

Bidding	Maximize Conversions, no Target CPA	No guardrail
Daily budget	\$50/day (~\$1,520/mo)	Losing 22% of impressions to budget

One ad group is doing too many jobs.

Basement-permit terms, generic building-permit terms, "city permit" terms and "drawings" terms all sit in a single ad group pointing at one ad and one landing page. Splitting them into **tightly themed ad groups** (e.g. Legal Basement / Second Unit, Basement Permit Drawings, Building Permit — Residential) lets the ad headline and landing message match the search — which directly lifts Quality Score and conversion rate.

4 Visibility & impression share

Impression share tells you how much of the available audience you actually reach. You are capturing only **34%** — and the reason is mostly quality, not money.

34.0%

IMPRESSIONS WON

43.8%

LOST TO AD RANK (QUALITY/BID)

22.2%

LOST TO BUDGET

The **43.8% lost to rank is nearly double the 22.2% lost to budget**. That is the account telling you, in Google's own words, that **relevance and Quality Score — not spend — are the ceiling**. Raising the budget today would simply buy more expensive, low-Quality-Score clicks. The correct sequence is: **fix landing page & Quality Score first, then scale budget** into the headroom that opens up.

5 Keywords & Quality Score

The 15 keywords that received clicks, ranked by spend. Watch the **Post-Click (landing-page)** column — it is **Below Average almost everywhere**.

Keyword	Match	Cost	Clicks	Conv	CPA	QS	Landing-page QS
Building Permits Ontario	Phrase	\$407.09	60	2.0	\$203.54	n/a	—
Legal Basement Permit	Phrase	\$242.33	35	3.5	\$69.24	5	Below avg
City Building Permits	Phrase	\$190.85	25	0	—	4	Below avg
Basement Building Permit	Phrase	\$163.47	14	5.0	\$32.71	5	Below avg
Apply For Building Permit	Phrase	\$144.57	16	0	—	3	Below avg
Permit To Finish Basement	Phrase	\$105.43	15	0.5	\$209.92	3	Below avg
Basement Permit Drawings	Phrase	\$59.93	7	1.0	\$59.93	8	Average
Basement Remodel Permit	Phrase	\$48.03	7	0	—	n/a	—

Basement Drawing For Permit	Phrase	\$35.33	5	0	—	7	Below avg
Residential Building Permits	Phrase	\$27.70	5	1.0	\$27.70	2	Below avg
Basement Permit	Exact	\$20.84	3	0	—	3	Below avg
Permit For Basement Renovation	Phrase	\$14.12	2	0	—	5	Below avg
Building Permit Application	Phrase	\$7.01	2	0	—	1	Below avg
Building Permit For House	Phrase	\$3.72	1	0	—	n/a	—
How To Legalize Basement	Exact	\$1.93	1	0	—	3	Below avg

The pattern is unmistakable.

Of every keyword with a Quality Score, only one ("Basement Permit Drawings", QS 8) has a landing-page score that isn't Below Average — and it happens to be the page's best-matched theme. **The landing page is dragging the entire account's Quality Score down**, which is why CPCs are \$7+. The lowest scorer, "Building Permit Application" (QS 1), scores below average on all three components.

Other keyword notes

- **Two relevant terms are spending with zero leads:** "City Building Permits" (\$190.85) and "Apply For Building Permit" (\$144.57) — \$335 combined, 0 conversions. They are **on-target**, so the likely cause is the landing page, not the keyword. Keep them, fix the page, and re-judge in 30 days.
- **11 keywords have essentially no traffic** (0 clicks), several with 0 impressions — including a stray single-word keyword "requirements" and off-core terms like "Kitchen Remodel Permit," "Permit To Convert Garage To Living Space," "Homeowners Permit." These add clutter; prune or rehome them.
- **Match-type discipline is good** — everything is Phrase or Exact (no broad match spraying). The leakage comes from phrase **close variants**, which negatives will contain (Step 6).

6 Search terms & wasted spend

This is where we find money leaking to searches that will never become customers. An important caveat first:

Only ~34% of spend is visible here — and that's normal.

Google only itemizes search terms that clear a privacy threshold; low-volume queries stay hidden. The visible slice (\$507 of the \$1,472) still reveals the **waste patterns**, which almost certainly repeat in the hidden long tail. So treat the dollar figures below as the **visible floor, not the ceiling**.

Wasted-spend categories (visible search terms, 30 days)

Category	What people were really after	Visible waste
Government / city-portal	"permit department", "city of toronto building permits", permit lookup/status	\$82.46
Informational / DIY	"how to...", "legal basement requirements", "how long/how much"	\$73.84
Wrong service / property	"drawing for deck permit" (\$31.68), plumbing-only	\$35.39
Out-of-area	"building permit waterloo", Kitchener, London, Calgary, Edmonton	\$9.46
Visible off-target total		\$201.15

That is ~40% of the visible spend going to searches Vin cannot convert — and a strong signal that a similar share of the hidden 66% is doing the same. Note that **close variants of phrase keywords drive 68% of visible spend and essentially all of this waste**: the bare query **"building permit"** was the #1 visible spender (\$37.81, 9 clicks, 0 leads) and is the doorway most junk enters through.

Some negative work has already started — good.

Several wasteful terms already show an "Excluded" status (e.g. "permit department", "legal basement requirements", "city of brampton building permit"). The list below completes and systematizes it.

Recommended action — a structured negative-keyword list (attached as CSV)

A ready-to-import file of **76 negative keywords across 7 categories** accompanies this report (Vin_Engineering_Negative_Keywords.csv). Highlights:

- **Government/portal** — block "permit department", "portal", "lookup", "inquiry", plus **exact** negatives for "[city of toronto building permit]" so you keep genuine in-area buyers.
- **DIY/informational** — "how to", "how long", "do i need", "without a permit", "requirements", "checklist", "diy", "pdf".
- **Wrong service** — "deck", "pool", "fence", "shed", "driveway", "commercial", "demolition", "plumbing", "electrical".
- **Out-of-area** — "london ontario", "hamilton", "ottawa", "guelph", "barrie", "calgary", "edmonton" (keep your targeted GTA cities).
- **Hygiene** — "free", "cheap", "job", "salary", "course", plus competitor "[metro permits and design brampton]".

Two terms flagged for your judgment: negatives on "cost"/"how much" and "requirements" also block price/spec researchers — some of whom might still buy your fixed \$1,199 offer. Consider testing before making them permanent. Also confirm your true service radius before excluding Waterloo/Kitchener/Cambridge, which are currently **targeted** yet spent with no leads.

7

Landing page experience — the #1 lever

Ad destination: vingcinc.com/offers/vingcin-landing.html

We could not crawl the page directly for this audit (the site blocks automated requests), but we don't need to guess — **Google has already graded it for us.** The Below-Average post-click Quality Score repeating across virtually every keyword (Step 5) **is** Google's landing-page verdict, and it is the root cause of the account's two most expensive symptoms: the \$7.44 CPC and the 43.8% of impressions lost to rank.

Why this is the highest-ROI fix in the account.

Landing-page experience feeds Quality Score → Quality Score sets your CPC and your Ad Rank → Ad Rank governs impression share and position. Improving the page moves **all four at once**: cheaper clicks, more impressions in the same budget, better positions, and a higher conversion rate. No other single change compounds like this.

Recommended landing-page priorities (standard high-intent local-service best practice)

- **Message-match the ad, section by section.** The hero should repeat the exact promises the ads make — "Legal Basement Permit – \$1,199", "drawings + permit + build, one team", "licensed engineers / BCIN-certified", "avoid fines", "unlock rental income". Congruence between ad and page is precisely what the post-click score measures.
- **Build dedicated pages per theme** so "basement permit drawings" traffic and "legal basement / second unit" traffic each land on a page about **that**, not a generic offer. (Pairs with the ad-group split in Step 3.)
- **Above-the-fold conversion path:** a click-to-call phone number (tel: link) **and** a short form (name, phone, postal code, brief message) visible without scrolling — mobile is 72% of your traffic.
- **Trust signals:** BCIN / licensed-engineer credentials, Google review stars, number of basements legalized, service-area map, and a visible privacy link.
- **Speed & mobile:** ensure fast mobile load and a responsive layout — both are inputs to the landing-page experience score.

Recommendation: a manual UX + PageSpeed review of the live page is the natural next step to convert this diagnosis into a specific fix list.

8

Ad copy & creative

The single responsive search ad is a **relative strength**. Ad Strength is **"Good,"** all 15 headlines and 4 descriptions are approved, and the copy is benefit-led and specific.

What's working in the copy.

Strong, varied headlines — "Legal Basement Permit – \$1199", "Licensed Engineers & Builders", "BCIN-certified Permit Designs", "Rent Your Basement Legally", "Avoid Fines, Build Legally", "Free Basement Assessment" — cover price, credibility, outcome and urgency. This is a well-constructed ad.

Where to push it further

- **Add a second RSA** to each ad group so Google can test creative and your assets can graduate from "Pending" to graded faster.

- **Review the keyword-insertion headline** "{KeyWord:Vin Engineering Inc.}" — confirm the inserted search terms always read cleanly; consider pinning a brand or offer headline to position 1 for consistency.
- **Add / confirm ad assets:** sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets, a call asset and a lead-form asset all lift CTR and Ad Rank at no extra CPC — quick wins while the page is being rebuilt.
- **Tighten relevance** once ad groups are split (Step 3): a "drawings" ad group should lead with drawings headlines, a "second-unit / rental" group with rental-income headlines.

9 Geography, devices & schedule

Where the leads are (by user location)

City	Cost	Clicks	Leads	CPA	Read
Toronto	\$771.52	111	8	\$96.44	Your engine — 62% of leads
Mississauga	\$176.65	19	2	\$88.33	Efficient
Richmond Hill	\$66.41	8	1	\$66.41	Good
Cambridge (ON)	\$23.08	3	1	\$23.08	Tiny but efficient
Brampton	\$234.10	34	1	\$234.10	Expensive — watch
Vaughan	\$71.92	7	0	—	0 leads — monitor
Markham	\$54.28	7	0	—	0 leads — monitor
Oakville / Waterloo / Kitchener	\$74.39	9	0	—	0 leads — confirm service area

Geo-targeting error to fix now.

The campaign's targeted-location list includes **Cambridge, England (United Kingdom)** — almost certainly picked by mistake instead of (or alongside) Cambridge, Ontario. No UK spend has landed yet thanks to "Presence" targeting, but it should be removed before it ever does. (The United States is correctly excluded.)

Devices

Device	Cost	Leads	CPA
Mobile	\$1,031.61	10	\$103.16
Desktop	\$435.68	3	\$145.23
Tablet	\$5.06	0	—

Mobile is 70% of spend and 40% cheaper per lead than desktop. This makes the above-the-fold mobile experience (Step 7) doubly important. A modest desktop bid adjustment can be tested once tracking is confirmed.

Day of week

Day	Cost	Leads	CPA
Thursday	\$159.96	7	\$22.86
Sunday	\$338.66	3	\$112.80
Mon / Tue	\$567.82	2	\$283.91
Fri / Sat	\$218.66	0	—

Thursday is a standout and Fri/Sat produced no leads — but at only 13 total leads this is **too little data to daypart yet**. Watch it; don't cut on it.

Bidding & budget

- **Strategy:** Maximize Conversions with **no Target CPA**. This tells Google to spend the full budget for as many leads as possible with no efficiency ceiling — fine to **start**, but now that you have conversion history, add a **Target CPA** (begin near your current ~\$113 and tighten as Quality Score improves) so bidding chases efficiency, not just volume.
- **Budget:** \$50/day is losing **22% of impressions to budget**. Do **not** raise it yet — first fix the landing page and Quality Score so each dollar buys cheaper clicks, **then** scale into the rank headroom that opens up.
- **Optimization score 55.5%:** review Google's recommendations tab and apply only the ones consistent with this audit (ignore broad-match / Display-expansion / Search-Partners suggestions, which would undo your clean setup).



What's working well

A credible audit is balanced. Several things here are done right and should be **protected**, not "fixed":

- **Clean network setup** — Google Search only; no Search Partners or Display draining budget.
- **Correct local targeting type** — "Presence," so you pay for people actually in your service area.
- **Disciplined match types** — Phrase/Exact only, no broad-match spray.
- **Real conversion tracking** — lead forms and calls, not vanity events.
- **Strong ad copy** — "Good" Ad Strength, specific and benefit-led.
- **Healthy 6.21% CTR** — your ads earn clicks; the constraints are downstream (page & Quality Score).
- **Negative-keyword work already begun** — several waste terms already excluded.



Areas requiring optimization — prioritized checklist

Every recommendation in this audit, ranked by impact. This is your working punch-list.

#	Area	What to do	Priority
1	Landing page	Rebuild the landing experience to message-match the ads (price, one-team, BCIN/licensed, avoid-fines, rental income); above-the-fold click-to-call + short form; trust signals; fast mobile. Root cause of low QS & high CPC.	Critical
2	Quality Score	Treat as the outcome of #1 + #4. Re-check landing-page & expected-CTR components after the page and ad-group split ship.	Critical
3	Negative keywords	Import the attached 76-keyword CSV (government/portal, DIY, wrong-service, out-of-area, hygiene, competitor). Then review the hidden search-term tail monthly.	High
4	Account structure	Split the single "Residential" ad group into 3-4 tightly themed ad groups so ads & pages match intent.	High

5	Conversion tracking	Verify tag firing/dedup/primary settings; resolve the possible double-counted call actions; import qualified-lead / booked-job from CRM.	High
6	"building permit" close variants	Contain the bare "building permit" query (top spender, 0 leads) — isolate it in a well-negated ad group or lean on basement-specific exact match.	High
7	Geo targeting	Remove Cambridge, England (UK) . Confirm service radius for Waterloo/Kitchener/Cambridge-ON (spend, no leads).	Medium
8	Bidding guardrail	Add a Target CPA to Maximize Conversions (~\$113 to start; tighten as QS improves).	Medium
9	Ad creative	Add a 2nd RSA per ad group; add sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets, call & lead-form assets; sanity-check the keyword-insertion headline.	Medium
10	Zero-traffic / off-core keywords	Prune the stray "requirements" keyword and off-core terms (kitchen/bathroom/garage remodel); rehome the rest into themed ad groups.	Medium
11	Underperforming relevant keywords	Keep but monitor "City Building Permits" & "Apply For Building Permit" (\$335, 0 leads) — re-judge 30 days after the page fix.	Watch
12	Budget scaling	Once QS improves and CPCs fall, raise budget to reclaim the 22% lost to budget — not before .	Watch
13	Device bids	Consider a small negative desktop adjustment (CPA \$145 vs mobile \$103) after tracking is verified.	Watch
14	Ad schedule	Monitor the Thursday strength / Fri-Sat softness; revisit dayparting once you have 50+ leads of data.	Watch

→ 30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

First 30 days — stop the leaks, verify the foundation

- Import the negative-keyword CSV; remove Cambridge (UK); prune the stray/off-core keywords.
- Verify conversion tracking (firing, dedup, the double-counted calls) and mark the true primary action.
- Add a Target CPA (~\$113) to the bidding strategy.
- Brief and begin the landing-page rebuild.

Days 30-60 — fix the foundation, lift Quality Score

- Ship the rebuilt, message-matched landing page(s).
- Split into 3-4 themed ad groups; add a 2nd RSA and all ad assets per group.
- Import qualified-lead / booked-job conversions from the CRM.

Days 60-90 — scale what works

- Re-measure Quality Score, CPC and impression share; expect cheaper clicks and higher impression share.
- Tighten Target CPA; scale budget into the reclaimed rank/budget headroom.
- Expand into proven themes (e.g. second-unit/rental, basement drawings) and top cities (Toronto, Mississauga).

Realistic expectation — and what we won't over-promise.

Fixing the landing page and Quality Score should lower your cost-per-click and raise impression share, which together should bring the cost-per-lead down over 60–90 days while increasing lead volume within the same budget. We **can't** guarantee a specific number: this is a young, low-volume account, results depend on the rebuilt page and on your close rate, and Google's auction is outside anyone's control. What we **can** commit to is removing the waste, fixing the root cause, and measuring honestly.

Data & method: All figures pulled live from the Google Ads API (PPC Guru Google Ads MCP) for account 566-536-4039, last 30 days (Jun 23 – Jul 22, 2026), CAD. Costs converted from micros. **Assumptions to confirm:** target cost-per-lead and lead→job close rate (used to judge the \$113 CPA), and exact service-area radius. **Limitations:** conversion tag firing, de-duplication, attribution settings and the live landing-page HTML are not readable via the API and require a manual in-platform check; search-term dollar figures reflect the ~34% of spend Google itemizes, so true waste is somewhat higher.